SpeechGeek



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As 2013 marches boldly and coldly toward its final days, the online monolith that is Amazon is experimenting with its drone delivery service. Though (at the time of this publication) customers won't anticipate their bulk orders of lip balm to be delivered by autonomous robots until at least 2015, folks are increasingly curious about the most efficient way to obtain their purchases. While we certainly respect the innovation and sheer "woah"-ness of the delivery drones, your friendly neighborhood **SpeechGeek** plans to stick with our current strategy of providing prompt digital downloads for online purchases. As recognized digital publishers by the National Forensic League, your electronic copy of **SpeechGeek** scripts is all you need to get competing. Don't forget your suit, though. That's pretty important, too.

If you're in need of printed scripts, stopwatches, or buttons – we still have you covered! While we can't promise delivery via an automated drone just yet (maybe by the time we're publishing Season Thirty), we do promise to package and ship your items at quickly as our human hands can do it. Welcome to a new year and five new interp scripts!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pigskin

by Richard Shelton

SCENE ONE

MARK. Every family has rituals. Some involve particular foods, places, or behaviors. Our ritual centers on the pigskin.

DAD. Get 'yer jersey on, son. The game is about to begin.

MARK. My earliest memories practically have buffalo sauce stains. My father and I would sit next to each other on the couch, surrounded by the weekly smorgasbord of junky food my otherwise healthy mother would lovingly prepare.

DAD. (*shouting at television*) Come on, Murphries, you better deliver a victory this time.

MARK. Outside of football, my dad and I couldn't be more different. I guess you could say I was a bit softer than my dad. I preferred to read and listen to music while he…

DAD. (*screaming*) Murphries? What? Was there a bone in the Gatorade? BECAUSE YOU'RE CHOKING!

MARK. …was tougher than me. Very tough.

DAD. You've gotta be kidding me! Can't you take a hit?

MARK. As I got older, high school football seemed like the obvious path way to a little bit of father-son bonding. Unfortunately, the only one I ended up bonding with was J.T.

J.T. (*taunting MARK)* Come on, Mark. You'd better deliver a victory this time.

MARK. I don't know what made him tic.

J.T. What? Was there a bone in your Gatorade? Because you're choking.

MARK. But I knew one thing.

J.T. (*shoves)* Can't you take a hit?

MARK. He wouldn't be content until I was sacked.

SCENE TWO

(*MARK and J.T. are in uniform during a practice. The scene freezes when MARK addresses the audience.*)

J.T. (*grunts and stretches*) Hunh! Ungh! Ahhh… I tell you something, nothing gets me going like crushing bodies on a Saturday morning, eh?

MARK. (*to himself, rolling his eyes and adjusting his mouth guard)* Yeah, right.

J.T. What?

MARK. Huh?

J.T. What did you say?

MARK. Oh, nothing.

J.T. (*moves a bit closer to him*) So, you're telling me you didn't just mumble something under your breath?

The Best Worst Date

by Paul Owen

(STUART and Janice are meeting at a cafe for a blind date. STUART is in his twenties and quite apprehensive about this date. You can feel his nerves. He is quite charming when he wants to be. JANICE enters. She is in her late twenties and confidence enters the room before she does. She is always trying to appear completely composed even if she is a bit nervous.)

JANICE. Hello. Stuart?

(*STUART stands up and shakes her hand.*)

STUART. Yes, hi. Are you… Janice?

JANICE. Yes, it's nice to meet you.

(*They both sigh.*)

STUART. I have to admit I was a bit worried about a blind date like this, but I was nervous for nothing. Hopefully you feel the same way.

JANICE. I am pleasantly surprised. So, do you like this place? I've actually never been here before.

STUART. Really? Oh, I love this place. They make the best sandwiches you'll ever eat. The soups are great, too. (*to audience*) Dating is basically like jumping into a pit of burning lava. I hate it. I mean, I want a girlfriend because I am tired of spending all of my time alone. But let's be honest, she will ditch me if I do anything remotely stupid. She will. Not right away, of course, but if she thinks I am an idiot, it's over. No pressure, right?

JANICE. So, what's your favorite sandwich here?

STUART. (*to audience*) See? This is the first test. Don't screw this up. What is the best sandwich? I don't know! Something healthy? Spicy? Exotic? I don't know! (*to JANICE*) It's hard to say. So many of them are delicious. (*grins to audience*)

JANICE. (*to audience*) I recently read a study that said men were basically about as useful as a house pet—like a dog. They will fetch things for you, scare off the neighbors, and cuddle when you're sad. Maybe, in some ways, that is true, but I have been by myself for almost a year now. I am not at the point of desperation or anything, but, frankly, there are several clocks ticking here. This guy seems nice enough, and now I need make sure that I don't give off a bad vibe. "What sandwich is the best?" That was my best option for starting things off? Well, now I have to take a risk. I actually love the sand wiches with all of the meat. Surely he does too, right? (*to STUART*) I think I might try the Meat-and-Greet Special. Have you tried that one before?

STUART. (*to audience*) The Meat-and-Greet special? There's like 5 meats on that. Now what do I do? I always get the Veggie Jackson Classic: all greens, no meat. (*to JANICE*) I actually like the Veggie Jackson Classic. I'm trying to add more healthy things into my diet.

(*JANICE nods, trying to be convinced that this is true.*)

JANICE. That's… that's important. Everyone can do a little better in that department to be honest. (*to audience*) Really? A vegetarian? His manhood just went down by like twelve points. (*to STUART*) I just like a sandwich with some carnage, you know?

STUART. (*to audience*) Great, I am on a date with a female carnivore. I've heard about these girls. They seem so cool at first. They like burgers, steaks, and probably even a beer or two. But then, when they lose their cool, they go full on ape. They turn violent and end up abusing some poor vegetarian guy by questioning his manhood. I may not be the manliest guy, but dang it if I am not a man. Yeah, it's pretty clear: I failed this test. I eat a little girl's sandwich, and I like it. (*to JANICE*) I like my little girl sandwich, okay?

JANICE. What? (*beat*) Did you say you like your little girl sandwich?

STUART. Uh, yeah. I was just messing with you. (*laughs to himself*) I just meant… that just because it is a veggie sandwich doesn't make it a sissy lunch, you know? Just a healthy one. That's all I meant.

JANICE. I see. Well, so tell me a bit about yourself since, at this point, I really only know about your sandwich preference.

STUART. Well, I went to the North Carolina School of Communications. I do freelance acting and voice-overs for commercials.

JANICE. You know, come to think of it, your voice does sound familiar.

STUART. Really? Wow, that's been happening a lot lately. I go somewhere and people recognize me and say, "Hey! Aren't you in that commercial?" And I'm like, "Yeah, that's me." You know that insurance commercial with the gecko?

JANICE. Oh my gosh, the gecko? That's your voice?

STUART. Not exactly. I'm the guy sitting in the back talking on the phone.

JANICE. Oh.

STUART. You know Mama Cecelia's commercial with the guy singing opera in the restaurant?

JANICE. Were you singing? You have a great voice.

STUART. I'm the guy eating the bread stick and laughing, like this… (*he demonstrates*)

JANICE. (*to audience*) I mean, I guess I should act impressed, right? He's been on TV, but he's not exactly climbing the ladder. Maybe he will… (*to STUART*) That's really great. I mean, you have to start somewhere, right?

STUART. Exactly. And even though I am starting to get noticed around town, it isn't affecting me. I think our hostess even recognized me, but the point is that I have made a bold decision. I will never let fame or money change me. I will always be the real me. So, what about you? What do you do?

JANICE. I'm studying clinical psychology. (*beat*)

STUART. (*to audience*) There are two professions that make no sense to me. This has to be at the top of the list. No wonder she analyzed my

sandwich selection. It probably tells her that I was abused as a kid or something. So now she thinks I only eat cucumbers and lettuce because of some subconscious need. This is perfect. I'm on a date with a therapist. (*to JANICE*) Clinical psychology, that's great!

JANICE. I know! I just finished an abnormal psychology class and the theories are so interesting.

STUART. Well, let's have it. What's the latest theory?

JANICE. One resurfaced recently from Robert Zajonc. He believes that married couples begin to look more and more like each other over time mostly due to shared empathy. He also discusses the power of staring.

STUART. Staring?

JANICE. Yes, staring. In one study, if a person holding a grocery bag stares at you then drops the bag, you are more likely to help him than anyone else.

STUART. Maybe because you are just freaked out by the creeper who's been staring at you.

JANICE. Well, maybe, but isn't it fascinating? Carl Gustav once said that everything that irritates us about others can lead us to a deeper understanding of ourselves.

STUART. I can see how that one might make sense.

JANICE. What do you mean by "that one"?

STUART. Hmm? (*He doesn't see what's coming yet.)*

JANICE. You said, "That one might make sense." You think the other theories don't? (*another beat*)

STUART (*to audience*) There are two reasons why I don't like therapists. First, they analyze everything. She made fun of my sandwich; I'll have a little fun myself. (*to JANICE*) Are you trying to analyze me here, in a cafe, on a first date? Really?

JANICE. No, I just wondered why you think the other theories don't make sense, that's all. Look, I'm sorry. I read into things too much some times. I am not exactly the world's best conversationalist.

STUART. I was kidding. You can analyze me if you want. It might be fun, actually. Maybe you can discover some hidden issues.

JANICE. Oh, I don't say "issues." I say "obstacles" because it takes away guilt and blame. It keeps things focused on an external factor first. Then we move to the internal ones.

STUART. So, have you ever uncovered some real major issues, or, I mean, obstacles in anyone so far?

JANICE. Oh, all the time. One patient was convinced that he was his own mother and they were currently not on speaking terms.

STUART. Wow.

JANICE. And another thought her son was her goldfish.

STUART. Wait, aren't you supposed to keep all of this confidential?

JANICE. I don't have patients yet; I have just questioned people for my tests. Though I have to say, I think I actually did help one lady. We

attempted to cross her bridge of impossibility.

STUART. I'm sorry. Her what?

JANICE. Bridge of impossibility.

STUART. I'm sorry. Not that I would attempt to analyze you, but wouldn't a bridge of impossibility be impossible to cross? No offense, but you have to agree that it sounds pretty funny.

JANICE. Look, I don't expect you to understand a theory like this. It might require a bit more brainpower than, say, eating a bread stick on television.

STUART. Oh, I see. Well, it usually doesn't take doctors long to belittle the rest of us. And I wasn't just eating a bread stick. I was giving a significant emotional response.

JANICE. Oh, I'm sorry—a significant emotional response. That sounds much harder.

STUART. It is, actually.

JANICE. So on the levels on emotional responses, where does eating a breadstick and being a background office worker rank?

STUART. There are so small roles, only small actors.

JANICE. (*to audience*) Okay, I am probably overreacting to all of this, but really? The "only small actors" line? I have to go after that. (*to STUART*) Does it bother you that you have had smaller roles?

STUART. (*to audience*) Here we go. She wants to analyze me? Bring it on. (*to JANICE*) In all honesty, yes. It does. (*She reacts proudly as if she has begun to discover the "obstacles."*) For me, this all started back when I was a kid and played Twister with my uncle.

JANICE. What?

STUART. Yeah, and it just spiraled from there. It's like a series of bad dreams that I couldn't wake up from... like... a bridge of impossibility. (*He grins and then she realizes.*)

JANICE. (*to audience*) So this guy I've never met comes in here and starts mocking my profession? (*to STUART*) Well, I suppose you think it's funny to just make fun of what I do.

STUART. Yes, because you assumed that I had an issue in my childhood.

JANICE. Obstacle.

STUART. Whatever. I love what I do, okay? I don't care how famous or non-famous I become. Isn't that enough? Love can sway even the mightiest of men.

JANICE. So can a Twinkie. Or, I'm sorry, in your case a cucumber sandwich.

STUART. Enough with the sandwich! Geez. It's bread with stuff in the middle. That's it.

JANICE. So, were you abused? That would explain all of the veggies.

STUART. Are you serious? You cannot be serious. I was so worried all week about this date and if I would say something to screw it up, and it really was the first thing I said. So what? I am attracted to you and think about what it would be like to have a girlfriend like you... but if my love of cucumbers is that weird, then I'm sorry to have wasted

your time. I did play Twister—a lot. (*she reacts*) NOT WITH MY UNCLE! With my friends. I even had a Barbie that I kept as a kid. And I listened to "The Nutcracker Suite" every night and danced around to the "Sugar Plum Fairies." Yes. I DID. And now I am in this cafe confessing it all to a near perfect stranger who also happens to be a therapist. (*to audience*) This is the second reason why I can't stand therapists. They actually work on me.

JANICE. Wow. That was…wow. Look, I'm sorry for what I said about the breadstick and the sandwich. We clearly opened up a lot of issues here.

STUART. Don't you mean, obstacles?

JANICE. (*stares him down*) No, I mean issues! Issues, okay? Let everyone in the whole freaking world know that I said "issues!" You have been making fun of me under your breath this whole time, haven't you? Is it because you think that psychology is all some big joke? Well, you asked me to analyze you, so fine. I will.

STUART. Wait, no. Please, don't start opening up…

JANICE. Oh, no. If it's all a big joke, then nothing I say will be true, right?

STUART. Right.

JANICE. Let's start with the fact that you played with Barbie dolls. Isn't that step one out of eight to becoming a serial killer? And let me also point out that playing Twister is sketchy no matter who you play it with for so many obvious reasons, but my question is why you would bring all of this up to me when you are trying to mock my profession. I think I know why you don't believe in therapy. It's because your mom is a therapist, isn't it?

STUART. (*to audience*) Holy crap.

JANICE. And she worried about you and caused you to grow up with all of these paranoid ideas and insecurities. She probably didn't support your acting ambitions either. That makes sense. After all, actors do have one of the easiest jobs on earth. Most of them dropped out of school to spend their time sucking face with every living thing they can find all in the name of "rehearsal." They are always victimizing themselves and then blaming the people who actually put up with all of their crap and pay their bills. But, for the love of all that's good, never criticize them for anything because their precious, tender emotions cannot take any scolding at all. Then they end up feeling like failures when they are stuck doing local restaurant commercials and children's educational shows. All the while, they drag everyone else down with them! It's an endless cycle of depression, medica tions, crying on the sofa, eating Hot Pockets and Funions crying in the car, boxes and boxes of tissue, crying at the table, anxiety, emotional breakdowns, panic attacks, and all the while everyone else around them ends up being the bad guy! So, yeah, I CAN SEE WHY YOUR MOM ISN'T EXACTLY SUPPORTIVE OF YOUR ACTING CAREER!

(*STUART just sits there. He is in shock then has a realization which he indicates to the audience.)*

STUART. (*to audience*) What just happened? First of all, she knows some of my obstacles I've been facing. Wait, did I say obstacles? (*he sighs*) I think it is safe to say that I have officially screwed up this date. (*to JANICE*) I am really sorry if I upset you.

JANICE. I'm fine. Wow, I am so sorry for that whole, whatever that was. I've never shared with or been that open with someone so quickly.

STUART. Yeah, me neither. I am, like, angry and happy at the same time.

JANICE. I know what you mean! It's like I don't know whether to punch you or kiss you.

STUART. What?

JANICE. What did I say?

STUART. You said kiss.

JANICE. I said kiss? Wow. I did. I feel like my defenses are down at the moment.

STUART. I know. I never thought I'd share the whole Barbie thing with any living soul.

JANICE. I feel like I could confess anything right now.

STUART. Me, too. I could even order a triple meat sandwich.

JANICE. I could even order that veggie thing. I could, and I might actually enjoy it.

STUART. So, you aren't going to leave tonight and forget me forever?

JANICE. I couldn't. I don't want to.

STUART. (*to audience*) Wow, how did this happen? It's like I struck out and hit a home run at the same time. Okay, question number two. The sandwich one failed so this one needs to really count. (*to JANICE*) You know a little about me and the fact that my mom is a therapist. Tell me something about your family. What does your dad do?

JANICE. (*beat*) He's an actor.